

Algebraic Topology 3

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Abstract

Algebraic Topology 3 picks up from Algebraic Topology 2 and defines the final invariant for homotopy equivalence called the homotopy groups. We shall see that such homotopy groups is a complete invariant for CW-complexes up to homotopy equivalence. CW-complexes also benefit from the homotopy groups with the homotopy analogue of excision and a unique new theorem called the suspension theorem that implies stability of the homotopy groups.

References:

- Notes on Algebraic Topology by Oscar Randal-Williams:
The first chapter gives a complete treatment of the first three sections of these notes, as well as providing the importance of fibrations on the higher homotopy groups. These notes are highly recommended to understanding the first three sections.
- Algebraic Topology by Allen Hatcher:
A more or less complete dictionary on all topics of these notes. However it is prone to the same problem in the sense that Hatcher's book is rather terse and definitions and parts of some theorems are scattered throughout the paragraphs rather than having a complete statement for reference. Nevertheless it is still the standard reference of the notes, albeit organized in a slightly different way.
- A non-visual proof that higher homotopy groups are abelian by Shintaro Fushida-Hardy:
This short piece of article proves that the higher homotopy groups are abelian in a purely algebraic way. Most geometric visualization of such a proof has the same underlying idea as the algebraic method.

Contents

1	Topics in Unstable Homotopy Theory	2
1.1	Excision for Homotopy Groups	2
1.2	The Homotopy Groups of a Fiber Bundle	3
2	Introduction to Stable Homotopy Theory	4
2.1	Freudenthal Suspension Theorem	4
2.2	The Stable Homotopy Groups	5
3	Bonus?	7
3.1	Postnikov Towers	7
4	Kunneth Theorem for Homology	8
4.1	The Universal Coefficient Theorem for Homology	8
4.2	Kunneth Theorem for Homology	8
5	Spectral Sequences in Algebraic Topology	9
5.1	Spectral Sequences in Topology	9
6	H-Spaces	11
6.1	H-Spaces and the Hopf Algebra Structure on Cohomology	11
6.2	Homotopy Associative H-Space and the Pontryagin Product	11
6.3	Group Like H-Spaces	12
7	The Free Monoid of a Space	13
7.1	The James Construction	13
7.2	The Infinite Symmetric Product	13
8	The Super Lie Algebra Structure in Homotopy Groups	15
8.1	The Samelson Product	15
8.2	The Whitehead Product	15
8.3	The Hilton Milnor Theorem	16

1 Topics in Unstable Homotopy Theory

1.1 Excision for Homotopy Groups

Theorem 1.1.1 (The Homotopy Excision Theorem (Blaker's Massey Theorem)) Let X be a CW-complex and A, B be sub complexes such that $X = A \cup B$ and $A \cap B \neq \emptyset$. If $(A, A \cap B)$ is m -connected and $(B, A \cap B)$ is n -connected for $m, n \geq 0$, then the map

$$\pi_k(\iota) : \pi_k(A, A \cap B) \rightarrow \pi_k(X, B)$$

induced by the inclusion $\iota : (A, A \cap B) \rightarrow (X, B)$ is an isomorphism for $0 \leq k < m + n$ and a surjection for $k = m + n$.

Proof We prove this by considering successively more general cases, starting from the simplest one.

Case 1: A is obtained from $A \cap B$ by attaching some e_{α}^{m+1} -cells and B is obtained from $A \cap B$ by attaching one e^{n+1} -cell.

We want to show that the map $\pi_k(A, A \cap B) \rightarrow \pi_k(X, B)$ is surjective. Let $f : (I^k, \partial I^k, J^{k-1}) \rightarrow (X, B, x_0)$ represent an equivalence class in $\pi_k(X, B)$. Since f is continuous, f preserves compactness and hence the image of f is compact. By a property of CW complexes, $\text{im}(f)$ meets only finitely many of the cells e_{α}^{m+1} and e^{n+1} . ■

Proposition 1.1.2 Let (X, A) be a pair of r -connected CW complexes and let A be s -connected. Then the map

$$p_* : \pi_k(X, A) \rightarrow \pi_k(X/A)$$

induced by the quotient map $p : X \rightarrow X/A$ is an isomorphism for $0 \leq k \leq r + s$ and a surjection for $k = r + s + 1$.

1.2 The Homotopy Groups of a Fiber Bundle

Theorem 1.2.1 Let $p : E \rightarrow B$ be a fiber bundle. Let $A \subseteq B$. Let $y_0 \in E$ and $p(y_0) = x_0$. Then there is an isomorphism

$$\pi_n(E, p^{-1}(A), y_0) \cong \pi_n(B, A, x_0)$$

given by the induced map p_* for all $n \geq 2$.

2 Introduction to Stable Homotopy Theory

2.1 Freudenthal Suspension Theorem

Theorem 2.1.1 (Freudenthal Suspension Theorem) Let X be an n -connected CW complex. Then for $0 \leq k \leq 2n$, the induced map

$$\Sigma_* : \pi_k(X) \rightarrow \pi_{k+1}(\Sigma X)$$

is an isomorphism. For $k = 2n + 1$, Σ_* is a surjection.

We can keep on suspending the space and the maps. Indeed if X is n -connected then, by Freudenthal suspension theorem ΣX is $(n + 1)$ -connected. We can then apply the suspension theorem again on ΣX and we see that $\Sigma^2 X$ is $(n + 2)$ -connected.

The following theorem is also said to be the Freudenthal suspension theorem.

Theorem 2.1.2 Let Y be $(n - 1)$ -connected. Consider the reduced suspension functor $\Sigma : \mathbf{hTop}_* \rightarrow \mathbf{hTop}_*$. Then $\Sigma : [X, Y] \rightarrow [\Sigma X, \Sigma Y]$ is bijective if $\dim(X) < 2n - 1$. Moreover, it is a surjection if $\dim(X) = 2n - 1$.

Corollary 2.1.3 There is an isomorphism

$$\pi_{n+k}(S^n) \cong \pi_{n+k+1}(S^{n+1})$$

for all $n \geq k + 2$.

Proposition 2.1.4 Let X be a space. Let $k \in \mathbb{N}$. Then the the following sequence of suspensions

$$\pi_k(X) \rightarrow \pi_{k+1}(\Sigma X) \rightarrow \pi_{k+2}(\Sigma^2 X) \rightarrow \dots$$

are eventually isomorphisms.

Proof Let X be n -connected. There are two cases.

Let $k \leq 2n$. By Freudenthal suspension theorem, if $k \leq 2n$ then $\pi_k(X) \cong \pi_{k+1}(\Sigma X)$. Then ΣX is $(n + 1)$ -connected hence $\pi_{k+1}(\Sigma X) \cong \pi_{k+2}(\Sigma^2 X)$ is an isomorphism since $k + 1 \leq 2n + 2$. More generally, for $r \in \mathbb{N}$, $\Sigma^r X$ is $(r + n)$ -connected hence

$$\pi_{k+r}(\Sigma^r X) \cong \pi_{k+r+1}(\Sigma^{r+1} X)$$

is an isomorphism since $k + r \leq 2n + 2r$.

Now if $k > 2n$, then there exists $r \in \mathbb{N}$ such that $k + r \leq 2n + 2r$. Such an r is given by say $k - 2n$. Then by Freudenthal suspension theorem,

$$\pi_{k+r}(\Sigma^r X) \cong \pi_{k+r+1}(\Sigma^{r+1} X)$$

is an isomorphism. More generally, for $m \in \mathbb{N}$, $\Sigma^{r+m} X$ is $(r + m + n)$ -connected hence

$$\pi_{k+r+m}(\Sigma^{r+m} X) \cong \pi_{k+r+m+1}(\Sigma^{r+m+1} X)$$

is an isomorphism since $k + r + m \leq 2n + 2r + 2m$. ■

2.2 The Stable Homotopy Groups

In Algebraic Topology, we refer to a property or invariant being stable if applying the suspension functor to the space does not change the property (up to possibly a shift in index). The first such example is one we have already encountered.

Definition 2.2.1 (Stable Homotopy Groups) Let X be a space. Let $n \in \mathbb{N}$. Define the n th stable homotopy groups of X to be

$$\pi_n^s(X) = \operatorname{colim}_{k \rightarrow \infty} \pi_{n+k}(\Sigma^k X)$$

This is well defined because of the Freudenthal suspension theorem, which states that the groups in the direct limit eventually stabilize. Indeed, the same theorem shows the following.

Proposition 2.2.2 Let X be a space. Then there is an isomorphism

$$\pi_n^s(X) \cong \pi_{n+1}^s(\Sigma X)$$

induced by the suspension functor between stable homotopy groups for any $n \in \mathbb{N}$.

Proof This can be seen by simply unwinding the definitions. We have that

$$\begin{aligned} \pi_{n+1}^s(\Sigma X) &= \operatorname{colim}_{k \rightarrow \infty} \pi_{n+k+1}(\Sigma^{k+1} X) \\ &= \operatorname{colim}_{k \rightarrow \infty} \pi_{n+k}(\Sigma^k X) \\ &= \pi_n^s(X) \end{aligned}$$

and so we conclude. ■

New: Graded ring structure on π_*^s .

Recall that for $n \geq 2$, the set $[\Sigma^2 X, Z]$ for any spaces X and Z are abelian. Moreover, the suspension map $\Sigma : [\Sigma^2 X, Z] \rightarrow [\Sigma^3 X, \Sigma Z]$ is a group homomorphism. In particular, we can choose $Z = \Sigma^2 Y$. Now since the category **Ab** of abelian groups is cocomplete, the following inverse system

$$[\Sigma^2 X, \Sigma^2 Y] \xrightarrow{\Sigma} [\Sigma^3 X, \Sigma^3 Y] \xrightarrow{\Sigma} [\Sigma^4 X, \Sigma^4 Y] \longrightarrow \dots$$

has an inverse limit. This leads to the following definition.

Definition 2.2.3 (Set of Stable Homotopy Classes of Maps) Let X and Y be space. The set of stable homotopy classes of maps from X to Y is defined to be the abelian group

$$[X, Y]^s = \operatorname{colim}_{n \in \mathbb{N} \setminus \{0,1\}} [\Sigma^n X, \Sigma^n Y]$$

The following observation is crucial. When X and Y are pointed CW complexes, the abelian groups $[\Sigma^n X, \Sigma^n Y]$ also become stable under suspensions.

Theorem 2.2.4 Let X and Y be pointed CW complexes. Then the sequence of abelian groups,

$$[\Sigma^n X, \Sigma^n Y] \xrightarrow{\Sigma} [\Sigma^{n+1} X, \Sigma^{n+1} Y] \longrightarrow \dots$$

are isomorphic under the suspension functor for $n > \dim(X)$ and $n \geq 2$.

New: When X is compact, $[X, QY]_* = [X, Y]_*^s$.

Theorem 2.2.5 The stable homotopy groups define a collection of functors $\pi_n^s : \mathbf{CW}_* \rightarrow \mathbf{Ab}$ as follows.

- For X a pointed CW complex, $\pi_n^s(X)$ is the n th stable homotopy group of X
- For $f : X \rightarrow Y$ a map,

$$\pi_n^s(f) : \pi_n^s(X) \rightarrow \pi_n^s(Y)$$

is the image of f under the canonical map $[X, Y] \rightarrow [X, Y]^s$

Theorem 2.2.6 The stable homotopy functors $\pi_n^s : \mathbf{CW}_* \rightarrow \mathbf{Ab}$ for each $n \in \mathbb{N}$ defines a reduced homology theory.

This is untrue for the unstable homotopy groups. In particular, the fundamental group is not necessarily abelian.

3 Bonus?

3.1 Postnikov Towers

Definition 3.1.1 (Postnikov Towers) Let X be a path connected space. A Postnikov tower is the following commutative diagram

$$\begin{array}{ccccccc}
 & & X & & & & \\
 & & \downarrow & \searrow & \searrow & \searrow & \\
 \cdots & \longrightarrow & X_n & \xrightarrow{p_n} & X_{n-1} & \longrightarrow & \cdots \longrightarrow X_2 \xrightarrow{p_2} X_1 \xrightarrow{p_1} *
 \end{array}$$

such that the following are true.

- The maps $X \rightarrow X_n$ for each $n \in \mathbb{N}$ induces isomorphisms $\pi_i(X) \cong \pi_i(X_n)$ for $i \leq n$.
- $\pi_i(X_n)$ for $i > n$.
- Each $p_n : X_n \rightarrow X_{n-1}$ for $n \in \mathbb{N}$ is a fibration with fiber $K(\pi_n(X), n)$.

Theorem 3.1.2 Suppose that there is an inverse system of spaces

$$\begin{array}{ccccccc}
 & & \lim_{n \rightarrow \infty} X_n & & & & \\
 & & \downarrow & \searrow & \searrow & \searrow & \\
 \cdots & \longrightarrow & X_n & \xrightarrow{p_n} & X_{n-1} & \longrightarrow & \cdots \longrightarrow X_2 \xrightarrow{p_2} X_1 \xrightarrow{p_1} *
 \end{array}$$

The functor π_i for $i \in \mathbb{N}$ induces a cone in **Grp**. By definition of $\lim_{\leftarrow} \pi_i(X_n)$, there is a unique map

$$\lambda : \pi_i \left(\lim_{\leftarrow} X_n \right) \rightarrow \lim_{\leftarrow} \pi_i(X_n)$$

Then the following are true regarding λ .

- λ is surjective
- λ is injective if the maps $\pi_{i+1}(X_n) \rightarrow \pi_{i+1}(X_{n-1})$ are surjective for sufficient large n .

Proposition 3.1.3 Let X be a connected CW complex. Then there exists a Postnikov tower for X .

Proposition 3.1.4 Let X be a connected CW complex. Choose a Postnikov tower of X . Then there is a weak homotopy equivalence

$$X \simeq \lim_{\leftarrow} X_n$$

so that X is a CW approximation of $\lim_{\leftarrow} X_n$.

4 Kunnetth Theorem for Homology

4.1 The Universal Coefficient Theorem for Homology

Proposition 4.1.1 Let (X, A) be a pair of space. Let T be an abelian group. Then there exists a natural map $h : H_n(X, A) \otimes T \rightarrow H_n(X, A; T)$ such that $\text{coker}(h) \cong \text{Tor}_1^{\mathbb{Z}}(H_{n-1}(X, A), T)$ and a split exact sequence (that is not natural) of the form

$$0 \longrightarrow H_n(X, A) \otimes T \xrightarrow{h} H_n(X, A; T) \longrightarrow \text{Tor}_1^{\mathbb{Z}}(H_{n-1}(X, A), T) \longrightarrow 0$$

for any $n \in \mathbb{N}$. In particular, split exactness implies that there is an isomorphism

$$H_n(X, A; T) \cong H_n(X, A) \otimes T \oplus \text{Tor}_1^{\mathbb{Z}}(H_{n-1}(X, A), T)$$

for any $n \in \mathbb{N}$.

4.2 Kunnetth Theorem for Homology

Theorem 4.2.1 (The Eilenberg-Zilbur Theorem)

Let X, Y be spaces. Then $C_{\bullet}(X) \otimes_{\mathbb{Z}} C_{\bullet}(Y)$ and $C_{\bullet}(X \times Y)$ are chain homotopy equivalent, that is natural in X and Y .

Proposition 4.2.2 Let X and Y be CW-complexes. Let R be a principal ideal domain. Then there is a short exact sequence

$$0 \longrightarrow \bigoplus_{i+j=n} H_i(X; R) \otimes_R H_j(Y; R) \xrightarrow{\times} H_n(X \times Y; R) \longrightarrow \bigoplus_{i+j=n} \text{Tor}_1^R(H_i(X; R), H_{j-1}(Y; R)) \longrightarrow 0$$

induced by the cross product, that is natural in maps $f : X \rightarrow A$ and $g : Y \rightarrow B$. Moreover, this sequence splits.

5 Spectral Sequences in Algebraic Topology

5.1 Spectral Sequences in Topology

Theorem 5.1.1 Let X be a space. Let the following be a sequence

$$\emptyset \subset X_0 \subset X_1 \subset \cdots \subset X$$

of subspaces. Let G be an abelian group. Then the following data

- $A_{p,q} = H_{p+q}(X_p; G)$
- $E_{p,q} = H_{p+q}(X_p, X_{p-1}; G)$
- $i : H_{p+q}(X_p; G) = A_{p,q} \rightarrow H_{p+q}(X_{p+1}; G) = A_{p+1,q-1}$ (degree $(1, -1)$)
- $j : H_{p+q}(X_p; G) = A_{p,q} \rightarrow H_{p+q}(X_p, X_{p-1}; G) = E_{p,q}$ (degree $(0, 0)$)
- $k : H_{p+q}(X_p, X_{p-1}; G) = A_{p,q} \rightarrow H_{p+q-1}(X_{p-1}; G) = A_{p-1,q}$ (degree $(-1, 0)$)

defines an exact couple and hence a spectral sequence with E^1 page given by

$$E_{p,q}^1 = H_{p+q}(X_p, X_{p-1}; G)$$

where the differential $d : E_{p,q}^1 \rightarrow E_{p-1,q}^1$ is given by the composition

$$H_{p+q}(X_p, X_{p-1}; G) \xrightarrow{k} H_{p+q-1}(X_{p-1}; G) \xrightarrow{j} H_{p+q-1}(X_{p-1}, X_{p-2}; G)$$

The E_1 page of such a spectral sequence is given by

$$\begin{array}{ccccccc} \cdots & \longleftarrow & \cdots & \longleftarrow & \cdots & \longleftarrow & \cdots \\ & & H_3(X_1, X_0; G) & \longleftarrow & H_4(X_2, X_1; G) & \longleftarrow & H_4(X_3, X_2; G) \longleftarrow \cdots \\ & & & & & & \\ & & H_2(X_1, X_0; G) & \longleftarrow & H_3(X_2, X_1; G) & \longleftarrow & H_4(X_3, X_2; G) \longleftarrow \cdots \\ & & & & & & \\ & & H_1(X_1, X_0; G) & \longleftarrow & H_2(X_2, X_1; G) & \longleftarrow & H_3(X_3, X_2; G) \longleftarrow \cdots \end{array}$$

Things get interesting when we choose X to be a CW complex and we choose the filtration of X by the skeleton of X . Recall that we have the formula

$$H_{p+q}(X_p, X_{p-1}; G) \cong \begin{cases} C_p^{\text{CW}}(X; G) & \text{if } q = 0 \\ 0 & \text{otherwise} \end{cases}$$

Thus the E^1 page is only left with a chain complex at $q = 0$.

Let us also compute the derived couple of this exact couple or in other words, the E^2 page of the spectral sequence. This is more intuitive than the one thinks about on the definition of the derived couple. The $E_{p,q}^2$ slot is simply the homology of the chain complex at the (p, q) th slot. The direction of the maps of the E^2 page depends not on the choice of spectral sequence at all (In fact, the direction only depends on the page). Now in our case, the homology can be given by a known construct:

$$E_{p,q}^2 = \frac{\ker(d : H_{p+q}(X_p, X_{p-1}; G) \rightarrow H_{p+q-1}(X_{p-1}, X_{p-2}; G))}{\text{im}(d : H_{p+q+1}(X_{p+1}, X_p; G) \rightarrow H_{p+q}(X_p, X_{p-1}; G))} = H_{p+q}^{\text{CW}}(X; G)$$

Since the direction of the maps are now diagonal and when $q \neq 0$ we have $E_{p,q}^2 = 0$, all maps in E^2 are 0 and we are left with

$$H_0^{\text{CW}}(X; G) \quad H_1^{\text{CW}}(X; G) \quad H_2^{\text{CW}}(X; G) \quad H_3^{\text{CW}}(X; G) \quad \cdots$$

Theorem 5.1.2 (Leray-Serre Spectral Sequence) Let $p : E \rightarrow B$ be a Serre fibration with fibre F and path connected B . Suppose that the action of $\pi_1(B)$ on $H_*(F; G)$ is trivial. Then there is a first quadrant homological spectral sequence starting with E^2 and weakly converging to $H_\bullet(E; \mathbb{Z})$. Explicitly, there is a convergence

$$E_{p,q}^2 = H_p(B, H_1(F)) \Rightarrow H_{p+q}(E; \mathbb{Z})$$

6 H-Spaces

6.1 H-Spaces and the Hopf Algebra Structure on Cohomology

Definition 6.1.1 (H-Spaces)

Let X be a space. We say that X is a H-space if there exists a map $\mu : X \times X \rightarrow X$ and a point $e \in X$ such that the maps $x \mapsto \mu(x, e)$ and $x \mapsto \mu(e, x)$ are homotopic to the identity map.

Example 6.1.2

Let G be a topological group. Then G is a H-space.

Example 6.1.3

Let (X, x_0) be a pointed space. Then $\Omega(X, x_0)$ is a H-space.

Lemma 6.1.4

Let X be a H-space. Let Y be a space. Then $[Y, X]$ has multiplication and identity.

Proposition 6.1.5

Let X be a H-space with multiplication given by μ . Let R be a commutative ring. Suppose that the following are true.

- $H^0(X; R) \cong R$.
- $H^n(X; R)$ is a finitely generated free R -module for each $n \in \mathbb{N}$.

Then $H^*(X; R)$ is a Hopf algebra whose comultiplication is induced by μ^* .

6.2 Homotopy Associative H-Space and the Pontryagin Product

Definition 6.2.1 (Homotopy Associative H-Space)

Let X be a H-space. We say that X is homotopy associative if the two maps

$$(x, y, z) \mapsto \mu(x, \mu(y, z)) \quad \text{and} \quad (x, y, z) \mapsto \mu(\mu(x, y), z)$$

are homotopic.

Lemma 6.2.2

Let X be a space. Then X is a group like H-space if and only if X is a monoid object in $\mathbf{hTop}$.

Lemma 6.2.3

Let X be a homotopy associative H-space. Let Y be a space. Then $[Y, X]$ is a monoid.

Definition 6.2.4 (Pontryagin Product)

Let X be a homotopy associative H-space. Let R be a commutative ring. Define the Pontryagin product of X to be the composite

$$H_*(X; R) \otimes_R H_*(X; R) \xrightarrow{\times} H_*(X \times X; R) \xrightarrow{\mu_*} H_*(X; R)$$

where the first map is the cross product given by the Kunneth theorem.

Proposition 6.2.5

Let X be a homotopy associative H-space. Then the Pontryagin product gives a ring structure to the direct sum

$$H_*(X; R) = \bigoplus_{n=0}^{\infty} H_n(X; R)$$

6.3 Group Like H-Spaces

Definition 6.3.1 (Group Like H-Spaces)

Let X be a H-space. We say that X is group like if the following are true.

- X is homotopy associative.
- There exists a map $j : X \rightarrow X$ such that $\mu \circ (\text{id}, j)$ and $\mu \circ (j, \text{id})$ are homotopic to the identity map.

Lemma 6.3.2

Let X be a space. Then X is a group like H-space if and only if X is a group object in $\mathbf{hTop}$.

Lemma 6.3.3

Let X be a group like H-space. Let Y be a space. Then $[Y, X]$ is a group.

Proposition 6.3.4

Let X be homotopy associative H-space. Then X is group like if and only if the map $(x, y) \mapsto (x, xy)$ is a homotopy equivalence.

Definition 6.3.5 (Homotopy Commutative H-Space)

Let X be a H-space. We say that X is homotopy commutative if the two maps

$$(x, y) \mapsto \mu(x, y) \quad \text{and} \quad (x, y) \mapsto \mu(y, x)$$

are homotopic.

Lemma 6.3.6

Let X be a space. Then X is a group like H-space if and only if X is an abelian group object in $\mathbf{hTop}$.

Proposition 6.3.7

Let X be a pointed space. Then the following are true.

- ΩX is a group like H-space.
- $\Omega^2 X$ is group like homotopy commutative H-space.

7 The Free Monoid of a Space

7.1 The James Construction

Definition 7.1.1 (James Reduced Product)

Let (X, e) be a pointed space.

- Define $J_n(X) = \frac{X^n}{\sim}$ where $(x_1, \dots, x_{i-1}, e, x_{i+1}, \dots, x_n) \sim (x_1, \dots, x_i, e, x_{i+2}, \dots, x_n)$.
- Define the James reduced product of (X, e) to be

$$J(X) = \text{colim}_{n \in \mathbb{N}} J_n(X)$$

Lemma 7.1.2

Let (X, e) be a CW complex where e is a 0-cell. Then $J(X)$ is a CW complex.

Proposition 7.1.3

Let X be a connected CW complex. Let R be a ring. Suppose that $H_*(X; R)$ is a free R -module. Then there is an isomorphism

$$H_*(J(X); R) \cong T(\tilde{H}_*(X; R))$$

Let (X, x_0) be a pointed space. Recall that the suspension of X is defined to be

$$\Sigma X = \frac{X \times I}{X \times \partial I \cup \{x_0\} \times I}$$

Elements of ΣX look like (x, t) where $x \in X$ and $t \in I$. Since $(x, 0) \sim (x, 1)$ in the quotient, the map $t \mapsto (x, t)$ is a well defined loop in ΣX , hence an element of $\Omega \Sigma X$.

Proposition 7.1.4

Let (X, e) be a pointed connected CW complex where e is a 0-cell. Let $\lambda : J(X) \rightarrow \Omega \Sigma X$ be the map defined by $\lambda(x) = (t \mapsto (x, t))$. Then λ is a homotopy equivalence.

7.2 The Infinite Symmetric Product

Definition 7.2.1 (Infinite Symmetric Product)

Let (X, e) be a pointed space.

- Define $SP_n(X) = \frac{X^n}{S_n}$ the orbit space, where S^n acts on X^n by $\sigma \cdot (x_1, \dots, x_n) = (x_{\sigma(1)}, \dots, x_{\sigma(n)})$.
- Define the infinite symmetric product of X to be

$$SP(X) = \text{colim}_{n \in \mathbb{N}} SP_n(X)$$

where the maps $SP_n(X) \hookrightarrow SP_{n+1}(X)$ is given by inclusion: $(x_1, \dots, x_n) \mapsto (x_1, \dots, x_n, e)$.

Lemma 7.2.2

Let (X, e) be a pointed space. Then there is a homeomorphism

$$SP(X) \cong \text{colim}_{n \in \mathbb{N}} \frac{J_n(X)}{S_n}$$

where S_n acts on $J_n(X)$ by $\sigma \cdot (x_1, \dots, x_n) = (x_{\sigma(1)}, \dots, x_{\sigma(n)})$.

Theorem 7.2.3 (Dold-Thom Theorem)

Let (X, e) be a pointed space. Then there are isomorphisms

$$\tilde{H}_n(X) \cong \pi_n(SP(X), e)$$

for each $n \in \mathbb{N}$.

Proposition 7.2.4

Let (X, e) be a pointed space. Then we have a factorization

$$\begin{array}{ccc} \pi_n(X, e) & \xrightarrow{\text{incl}_*} & \pi_n(\text{SP}(X), e) \\ & \searrow h_n & \nearrow \cong \\ & \tilde{H}_n(X) & \end{array}$$

where h is the Hurewicz homomorphism.

8 The Super Lie Algebra Structure in Homotopy Groups

8.1 The Samelson Product

Definition 8.1.1 (Samelson Product)

Let X, Y be spaces. Let G be a group like H -space. Let $f : X \rightarrow G$ and $g : Y \rightarrow G$ be maps. Define the Samelson product $[f, g] : X \wedge Y \rightarrow G$ by

$$[f, g] = [-, -] \circ (f \wedge g)$$

where $[-, -]$ is the commutator map on G .

Note that the Samelson product is well defined because the commutator map $[-, -] : G \times G \rightarrow G$ is trivial on $G \wedge G$ and so it descends to a map $G \wedge G \rightarrow G$.

Proposition 8.1.2

Let G be a group like H -space that is 0-connected. Then the following are true.

- The map $\pi_n(G) \times \pi_m(G) \rightarrow \pi_{n+m}(G)$ given by $([f], [g]) \mapsto [f, g]$ is a $\mathbb{Z}$ -bilinear map.
- Let $[f] \in \pi_n(G)$ and $[g] \in \pi_m(G)$. Then we have

$$[f, g] = (-1)^{nm+1}[g, f]$$

Proposition 8.1.3 (The Super Jacobi Identity)

Let G be a group like H -space that is 0-connected. Let $[f] \in \pi_n(G)$, $[g] \in \pi_m(G)$ and $[h] \in \pi_k(G)$. Then we have

$$(-1)^{nk}[f, [g, h]] + (-1)^{nm}[g, [h, f]] + (-1)^{mk}[h, [f, g]] = 0$$

Corollary 8.1.4

Let G be a group like H -space that is 0-connected. Then $\pi_*(G)$ is a super Lie algebra.

8.2 The Whitehead Product

Definition 8.2.1 (The Whitehead Product)

Let X be a pointed space. Define the Whitehead product on X to be the map $[-, -]_{\text{Wh}} : \pi_n(X) \times \pi_m(X) \rightarrow \pi_{n+m-1}(X)$ as follows. For $[f] \in \pi_n(X)$ and $[g] \in \pi_m(X)$, the Whitehead product is given by

$$[f, g]_{\text{Wh}} = (f \vee g) \circ \phi$$

where $\phi : S^{n+m-1} \rightarrow S^n \vee S^m$ is the attaching map of the $(n+m)$ -cell in the CW complex structure of $S^n \times S^m$.

Proposition 8.2.2

Let X be a pointed space. Let τ be the isomorphism $\pi_{n+1}(X) \cong \pi_n(\Omega X)$. Let $[f] \in \pi_{n+1}(X)$ and $[g] \in \pi_{m+1}(X)$. Then we have

$$\tau([f, g]_{\text{Wh}}) = (-1)^{n-1}[\tau([f]), \tau([g])]$$

Proposition 8.2.3

Let X be a pointed space.

- The Whitehead product $[-, -]_{\text{Wh}}$ is a $\mathbb{Z}$ -bilinear map.
- Let $[f] \in \pi_n(X)$ and $[g] \in \pi_m(X)$. Then we have

$$[f, g] = (-1)^{nm}[g, f]$$

Proposition 8.2.4 (The Super Jacobi Identity)

Let X be a pointed space. Let $[f] \in \pi_n(G)$, $[g] \in \pi_m(G)$ and $[h] \in \pi_k(G)$. Then we have

$$(-1)^{(n-1)(k-1)}[f, [g, h]] + (-1)^{(n-1)(m-1)}[g, [h, f]] + (-1)^{(m-1)(k-1)}[h, [f, g]] = 0$$

Corollary 8.2.5

Let X be a pointed space. Then $\pi_{*-1}(X)$ is a super Lie algebra.

8.3 The Hilton Milnor Theorem

Theorem 8.3.1 (Hilton-Milnor Theorem)

Let X, Y be connected spaces. Then there is a weak equivalence

$$\Omega\Sigma X \times \Omega\Sigma \left(\bigvee_{i=0}^{\infty} (Y \wedge X^{\wedge i}) \right) \rightarrow \Omega\Sigma(X \vee Y)$$

Corollary 8.3.2

Let X, Y be connected spaces. Then there is a zigzag of weak equivalence

$$\Omega\Sigma(X \wedge Y) \simeq \Omega\Sigma X \times \Omega\Sigma Y \times \Omega\Sigma \left(\bigvee_{i,j=1}^{\infty} (X^{\wedge i} \wedge Y^{\wedge j}) \right)$$

given by twice applying the Hilton-Milnor theorem.